

NARENDRANATH PANDA

Senior Platform Engineer | Kubernetes/EKS | AWS | IaC | Observability & Telemetry

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Bangalore, Karnataka, India (Relocation-Ready Canadian Permanent Resident)

Seasoned **Senior Platform Engineer / SRE Architect with 19+** years of experience designing, operating, and scaling large, distributed Kubernetes platforms across edge and cloud environments. Blends deep hands-on expertise in Kubernetes/EKS, AWS, and Infrastructure as Code (Terraform, Helm) with a strong focus on observability, telemetry, and operational excellence to deliver highly reliable, mission-critical systems. Proven track record leading incident management, global on-call rotations, and SLO/SLI-driven reliability programs, driving measurable reductions in downtime, deployment risk, and operational toil. Passionate about building resilient platforms, enabling developer velocity through automation and GitOps, and mentoring teams to adopt SRE best practices in fast-moving, product-centric organizations.

Experience

R&D Architect
Nokia

July 2013- Present
Bangalore, India

As a senior architect within a global R&D organization, I led strategic initiatives across platform modernization, SRE, security, and AIOps, delivering foundational improvements that enhanced reliability, accelerated development, and optimized costs.

Platform Modernization & Migration:

- **Orchestrated the zero-downtime migration** for a distributed estate of over 1000(Edge Nodes) Kubernetes clusters, mitigating risks from hardware and software upgrades by engineering redundant services and robust failover mechanisms to ensure high availability for critical DevOps infrastructure.
- **Led cross-functional teams to resolve fragmented modernization efforts**, facilitating workshops and defining clear strategies (containerization, cloud readiness) to achieve stakeholder consensus and enable seamless transitions for 8-9 key projects.
- **Architected and operated a reliable, highly available DC -Kubernetes platform** (both on-prem & AWS EKS) **and 1000+ Edge** k8s clusters using IAC (Terraform, Helm, GitOps), improving system resilience and resource efficiency.

SRE, DevOps & Developer Velocity:

- **Reduced deployment cycles by 50%** and achieved 99.95% platform availability by architecting and implementing a standardized CI/CD(Gitlab-ci) workflow based on GitOps principles (ArgoCD), resolving slow, manual deployments across 8 projects.
- **Streamlined product development by establishing and leading cross-team debugging "war rooms"** and root cause analysis sessions, resolving critical blockers through permanent fixes and preventive automation.
- **Directed a 15-engineer DevOps team**, implementing structured processes and DevOps best practices (IaC, CI/CD) to resolve inefficiencies and adopt a culture of proactive problem-solving and automation.
- **Designed and deployed a scalable observability and telemetry stack** (Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, OpenTelemetry), integrating edge node telemetry and defining SLIs/SLOs to improve system reliability and reduce infra costs by 5%.

Other (Incident management, AIOps, FinOps & Governance):

- Created a POC on AI driven **Git triage agent (RAG + Llama3)** to automate issue categorization for over 10,000 items, projecting a 40-50% reduction in manual effort and enabling one-click issue creation.
- **Addressed escalating cloud costs** by implementing a FinOps program that reduced spend by 15% YoY and avoided a projected \$500k overspend through automated policies and provider negotiations.
- **Automated and integrated compliance management** for over 300 FOSS components, streamlining software releases and mitigating legal and security risks.
- **Participated in a global 24/7 on-call rotation for mission-critical DevOps** and platform services, troubleshooting, coordinating multi-team response, postmortems, and follow-up actions

Sr. Developer

Misys

- Co-engineered a new Java-based framework for the flagship LoanIQ product, replacing a legacy Smalltalk system and boosting system performance by 50% for key clients like Bank of America.
- Functioned as Scrum Master, optimizing bug triage and development workflows which led to a 70% reduction in defect resolution time.

April 2011 – July 2013

Bangalore, India

IT Consultant

Logica CMG

- Developed and delivered robust Java applications for diverse sectors, including education, oil & gas, and banking & finance (e.g., University & College Application System, GIT Air Liquide, LanaUt Swedbank).
- Wrote efficient, maintainable, and scalable Java code with best practices and coding standards

July 2006 – Mar 2011

Bangalore, India

Skills

Architecture

Cloud-Native Architecture | Microservices | Serverless | Platform Engineering | Solution Design | Scalable Architectures | Resilient Architectures| Distributed Systems | SaaS | Troubleshooting | Multi-tenant Platforms

DevOps & CI/CD

GitLab CI | GitHub Actions | ArgoCD | GitOps | CI/CD Pipelines | Infrastructure as Code | Automation | Ansible| Helm

Observability

Prometheus | Grafana | DataDog | Victoria Metrics | Open Telemetry | Loki | Thanos | AIOps | Kafka | FluentD | OpenSearch Database | Distributed Tracing

Tools and Technologies

Terraform | Vault | Jenkins | SonarQube | Harbor | Ceph | Rook | Jira | Confluence | MS Teams | Slack

Methodologies

Team Leadership 15 | AIOps Strategy | DevSecOps | Cross-Functional Management | Agile/Scrum |Release Management

AI / ML / AIOps

AI Agent Design | Retrieval-Augmented Generation RAG | Large Language Models LLM Hosting & Prompting) |Model Context Protocol MCP | Vector Databases Pinecone/Chroma)

Education:

Birla Institute of Technology and Science, Pilani

Master of Technology -MTech

2015-2017

WILP

Utkal University Bachelor of Engineering, Odisha

Bachelor of Engineering, Information Technology

2000-2004

Key Achievements

Nokia Excellency Award

- Thanks for your contribution and mentorship 2025
- Successful NDAC DC migration 2025
- Excellence in Collaboration for MX Grid 2025
- Security supporter for SRE systems 2023
- Exceptional work for China setup DC 2023
- Recognized for exceptional work in setting up Data Centre in 2 months
- & many more...

Logica Diamond Award

- Delivering software with quality